

Immutable Backups

Immutable backups are backups that cannot be modified, deleted, or encrypted by unauthorized users, even if they gain access to the backup storage. Immutable backups are becoming increasingly important in the age of ransomware attacks, where hackers often target backups as a way to prevent businesses from recovering their data.

Immutable backups are typically achieved through the use of write-once-read-many (WORM) storage media, such as WORM tape or optical discs, or through cloud-based backup solutions that use immutability features. WORM storage media prevents data from being overwritten or deleted once it has been written to the media.

To set up immutable backups, you will need to select a backup solution that supports immutability, such as a cloud backup solution with immutability features, or a backup solution that allows you to write backups to WORM storage media. Once the backup solution is configured to use immutability, backups will be written to the storage media or cloud-based storage with an immutable flag, preventing unauthorized users from modifying or deleting the backups.

Immutable backups are used primarily for disaster recovery purposes, and are designed to protect businesses from data loss in the event of a cyberattack or other data loss event. Immutable backups can also help businesses meet regulatory compliance requirements by ensuring that backup data is preserved and cannot be tampered with.

In summary, immutable backups are a critical part of a comprehensive backup strategy, and businesses should consider implementing them to protect their data from ransomware attacks and other data loss events.

Possible Solutions

Several backup solutions support immutable backups, including:

1. Cloud backup solutions with immutability features: Many cloud backup solutions, such as Amazon S3 Glacier, Microsoft Azure, and Google Cloud Storage, offer immutability features that allow you to create immutable backups.
2. Backup solutions that use WORM storage media: Backup solutions that use WORM storage media, such as WORM tape or optical discs, can also create immutable backups. Examples of backup solutions that support WORM storage media include IBM Spectrum Protect, Commvault, and Veritas Backup Exec.
3. Backup solutions with immutability features: Some backup solutions, such as Veeam Backup & Replication and Rubrik, offer immutability features that allow you to create immutable backups.

When selecting a backup solution, it's important to consider whether it supports immutable backups and which type of immutability features it provides. It's also important to ensure that the backup solution is compatible with your storage infrastructure and meets your data protection and compliance requirements.